

HR Analytics - Executive Narrative

Assessment 5: Telling the Story in Power BI

1,470 Total Employees	237 (16.1%) Attrition Rate	38.9 Average Age	R7,676 Avg Monthly Salary
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Key Findings

The HR Analytics dataset covers 1,470 employees across three departments - Sales, Research and Development, and Human Resources. With 237 employees having left the organisation, the overall attrition rate stands at 16.1 percent. While this figure sits within broader industry benchmarks, the distribution of attrition is highly uneven across salary bands, age groups, job roles, and education fields, pointing to specific, addressable pockets of risk.

The most striking finding concerns salary. Employees earning up to R5,000 per month account for 129 of the 237 departures - more than half of all attrition - despite representing a fraction of total headcount. By contrast, employees earning above R15,000 account for only 7 departures. This inverse relationship between compensation and attrition is the single strongest signal in the data and points directly to where intervention will have the greatest impact.

Age is the second key dimension. Employees aged 26 to 35 account for 83 attritions, closely followed by the 36 to 45 group at 81. Together, these two cohorts represent 69 percent of all departures, suggesting that mid-career professionals - not entry-level staff - are the primary retention risk. These are employees with enough experience to be highly marketable and enough seniority to be costly to replace.

By job role, Laboratory Technicians lead attrition at 59 departures, followed by Sales Executives at 54 and Research Scientists at 44. These three roles alone account for 66 percent of all attrition. At the other end, Research Directors record only 2 departures and Managers only 6, suggesting that leadership-level retention is strong while technical and sales contributor roles carry the greatest risk. The matrix of job role against satisfaction score confirms that lower satisfaction scores - particularly scores of 1 and 2 - correlate with higher attrition across most roles.

From an education perspective, Life Sciences graduates account for 91 attritions (38.4 percent of the total) and Medical graduates for 76 (32.1 percent). Together, these two groups represent more than 70 percent of all departures. Tenure analysis on Page 2 of the report reveals that attrition peaks sharply in the first two years of employment, drops significantly by year five, and then stabilises - confirming that early-career retention is a critical window for the organisation.

Action-Oriented Recommendations

1**Recommendation 1 - Conduct an Urgent Compensation Review for Sub-R5,000 Earners**

With 129 of 237 attritions coming from the lowest salary band, the business case for a compensation review is overwhelming. Commission an immediate benchmarking study comparing the organisation's sub-R5,000 monthly salary band against industry peers. Where market data supports an adjustment, implement phased increases tied to performance milestones rather than flat raises. Prioritise Laboratory Technicians and Sales Representatives, as both roles combine low average salaries with the highest attrition counts. Target: reduce attrition in the Upto 5k band by 30 percent within 18 months of implementation.

2**Recommendation 2 - Implement a Structured Early-Tenure Retention Programme**

The tenure analysis confirms that the first two years of employment are the highest-risk window. Design a 24-month structured onboarding and development pathway for all new hires that combines mentorship, quarterly check-ins, clear 12-month and 24-month milestones, and a transparent salary progression schedule. Focus initial rollout on Research and Development and Sales, which together account for 208 of the 237 attritions. Success should be measured by a reduction in first-year attrition of at least 25 percent within two years.

3**Recommendation 3 - Address Mid-Career Development and Role Satisfaction for Technical Staff**

Laboratory Technicians, Research Scientists, and Sales Executives collectively account for 157 attritions - 66 percent of the total. Job satisfaction matrix data shows these roles concentrate on satisfaction scores of 1 and 2. Introduce a formal annual talent review for all employees in these three roles, create visible promotion pathways into senior technical tracks, and ensure that satisfaction survey results trigger a structured response within 30 days. Employees who see a credible career future within the organisation are substantially less likely to leave.

Conclusion

The HR Analytics data tells a coherent and actionable story. Attrition is concentrated among lower-paid employees in the Up to 5k salary band, among mid-career professionals aged 26 to 45, and in specific technical and sales roles - particularly Laboratory Technicians, Sales Executives, and Research Scientists. These patterns are not random;

they reflect systemic gaps in compensation competitiveness, early-career engagement, and mid-career development pathways. Implementing the three recommendations above - compensation review, early-tenure retention programme, and technical career pathway development - and tracking progress through this Power BI report every quarter will enable leadership to make evidence-based people decisions and meaningfully reduce the financial and operational cost of unwanted turnover.